MarginCOS

COMMERCIAL OPERATING SYSTEM

Stop guessing. Start recovering margin.

How MarginCOS finds and recovers the margin your P&L is silently losing - in under five minutes, from a single Excel upload.

3 - 6%	6 Modules	<5 Min
EBITDA Uplift	One Upload	Time to Insight

THE PROBLEM

Every FMCG and Manufacturing CFO in Nigeria Is Fighting the Same Battle.

40 - 60%

Input cost inflation since 2022

<30%

Of companies have SKU-level margin visibility

₦15 - 30M

Average Big Four diagnostic report cost

The result: pricing decisions made on instinct, not data. Margin absorbed instead of recovered.

MarginCOS was built to close this gap.

THE QUESTIONS NOBODY CAN ANSWER FAST ENOUGH

Six commercial questions. One platform. Under five minutes.

1. Which SKUs are absorbing inflation that should have been passed through?
2. Which promotions are destroying margin while the sales team celebrates volume?
3. Which channels are quietly financing distributors at your expense?
4. What does your P&L look like under the next cost shock - before it hits?
5. Which products should be repriced, protected, or delisted - right now?
6. Where is your willingness-to-pay headroom before volume breaks?

WHAT MARGINCOS DOES

One Upload. Six Engines. One Board-Ready Report.

01

UPLOAD

Your SKU, pricing, cost, and channel data - as a single Excel file. No ERP. No IT project.

02

ANALYSE

Six intelligent engines run simultaneously across your portfolio. Results in seconds.

03

ACT

A branded PDF diagnostic report, ready for your board. Plus an interactive dashboard to explore the data.

No ERP integration required · No consultant required · No waiting for month-end · Most clients live within 48 hours

Engines 1 – 3: Pricing, Cost Recovery, Channel Economics

① Pricing Intelligence

- SKU-level elasticity modelling
- Quantifies WTP headroom before volume breaks
- Impact of proposed price changes - before you move
- Flags SKUs priced below elasticity-adjusted optimum

② Cost Pass-Through

- Measures inflation recovered vs absorbed into margin
- RAG classification: Managed · Watch · At Risk
- Benchmarks vs industry leaders (~75% recovery target)
- Names the SKUs bleeding the portfolio

③ Channel Economics

- True cost of each route-to-market
- Hidden financing cost of trade credit (days × rate)
- Channels destroying margin through credit terms alone
- Price realisation gap vs portfolio average

Continued →

Engines 4 - 6: Trade Execution, Portfolio, Scenario Modelling

④ Trade Execution

- Every promotion: margin-accretive or destructive?
- Breakeven volume lift required per discount depth
- Net ₦ P&L impact of every trade promotion
- Identifies which promotions to cut, restructure, or keep

⑤ SKU Portfolio Rationalisation

- 2×2 matrix: margin contribution vs strategic volume
- Protect · Grow · Reprice · Review - per SKU
- Names specific reprice and delist candidates
- Quantifies margin at stake from dilutive SKUs

★ ENTERPRISE MODULE

⑥ Forward Inflation Scenarios

- Projects P&L under 20% - 75% cost inflation
- Five recovery rate scenarios simultaneously
- Worst-case monthly hit if zero action taken
- Board-ready table to anchor pricing commitments

★ ENTERPRISE MODULE

THE OUTPUT

A Board-Ready Diagnostic Report. In Under Five Minutes.

The MarginCOS PDF export delivers a branded, structured diagnostic across all six modules - ready to table at your next board or ExCo meeting.

- Five pages - one module per page
- RAG status, callout narrative, SKU-level tables
- Benchmarked against Nigerian FMCG leaders
- Priority action items with naira values attached
- Exportable with one click from the dashboard

What others charge

₦15 - 30M

Big Four diagnostic report

MarginCOS delivers the equivalent

in under 5 minutes

from your own data, at a fraction of the cost

WHO IT'S BUILT FOR

Built for organisations where margin is a board-level conversation.

FMCG

Multi-SKU portfolios facing dual pressure from input cost inflation and price-sensitive consumers.

Manufacturing

Companies with complex cost structures needing precision on which cost lines to recover and which to absorb.

Distribution & Retail

Businesses with multi-channel complexity where margin leaks silently through credit, discount, and channel mix.

Designed for:

MD/CEO

Portfolio-level margin visibility without waiting for month-end close.

CFO

Scenario planning and cost pass-through tracking anchored to real benchmark data.

Commercial Director

SKU-level pricing decisions, promotion ROI, and channel economics in one place.

HOW IT WORKS

Four steps. Most clients are live within 48 hours.

01

Download Template

Receive the MarginCOS Excel template. Pre-mapped columns for SKU master, pricing, cost structure, and channel data.

02

Upload Your Data

Upload your completed file. The platform validates every column and flags errors before analysis runs.

03

Review Findings

Six interactive modules render instantly. Drill into any pillar - see SKU-level detail, RAG status, and narrative callouts.

04

Export & Present

One-click PDF export. Five branded pages. Board-ready in under five minutes from upload.

PRICING

Three Tiers. Start with a 14-Day Free Pilot.

Essentials

From $239 /month

+$400 implementation

- 1 core pillar (P1)
- Single upload cycle
- SKU-level elasticity modelling
- PDF diagnostic export
- Email support

MOST POPULAR

Professional

From $749 /month

+$1,200 implementation

- All 4 margin pillars
- Advanced elasticity + regional segmentation
- Upload history & period switcher
- SKU Portfolio Rationalisation
- Forward Inflation Engine
- Priority support

Enterprise

Custom

4-week onboarding included

- Everything in Professional
- Channel Mix Optimisation
- Distributor Credit Scoring
- Multi-user access
- Dedicated analyst support
- And more…

Additional pricing tier details on www.margincos.com

BUILT BY

Carthena Advisory

MarginCOS is built and operated by Carthena Advisory - a financial and management advisory firm with over two decades of hands-on P&L work across FMCG, manufacturing, and financial services in Nigeria and West Africa.

We built the tool because our clients kept asking the same six questions. Now the platform asks them for you.

25+ Years	Advisory experience in Nigerian FMCG & manufacturing
₦B+	In client P&L work guided by the same analytical framework
5 Organisations	Currently on the MarginCOS platform as of March 2026

NEXT STEP

Start Recovering Margin Today.

Book a 30-minute diagnostic session. We'll show you exactly what MarginCOS finds on a portfolio like yours - before you commit to anything.

Book a Diagnostic Session →

Try the Free Demo →

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